

Ana Monroe

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Professional Summary

- Design and enterprise architecture leader with B2B SaaS and product expertise. 20 years of experience leading teams, with 10 in business development for high-impact national programs.
- Track record of building innovative new businesses in complex, ambiguous environments. Led large-scale strategic pivots and the development of new product- and service-generators for several federal agencies.
- Excels at building and leading multi-skill teams capable of collaborating across engineering, legal, operations, and customer-facing stakeholders to drive innovation and align execution with ambitious goals.

Core Competencies

Enterprise Architecture • Program Management • Business Strategy • Strategic Planning • Growth Strategy • B2B SaaS Customer Success • Digital Customer Experience • Stakeholder Engagement • Change Management • Systems Thinking • Product & Service Design • Data Design for Artificial Intelligence Deployment • Data Interpretation & Rationalization • Process Improvement • Cross-Functional Collaboration

Professional Experience

Program Manager

GENERAL SERVICES ADMINISTRATION (GSA) | 2021 – PRESENT

Leads at a director level for a Federal agency, reporting to the Chief Customer Officer (CCO) of Enterprise Digital Experience & Service Design. Bootstrap and oversee creation and growth of a first-of-its-kind digital customer experience team serving the GSA's 12,000 direct employees, 100+ federal agencies, and millions of public customers. Led identification of agency-wide strategic goals; set KPIs; collaborated with stakeholders throughout federal space to ensure ongoing alignment with shifting priorities. Own strategy and implementation for systematizing compliance with over 150 unique legal requirements for digital experience at the federal level. Develop and execute talent strategy for business unit, including recruiting and defining roles. Directly manage 7 remote team members; establish KPIs for 90 peers and 19 senior leaders. Collaborate across HR, IT, and business verticals to ensure implementation in alignment with strategic goals. For this work, awarded the national 2023 [Service to the Citizen award](#) by the Public Service Leadership Academy, an independent industry group.

SELECT ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Developed digital management strategy resulting in **\$11 million dollars** in increased agency profit.
- Defined measurement strategy for digital management currently being scaled across federal space, **affecting 2.3 million federal employees**.
- Boosted agency efficiency via a **37% reduction** in agency digital footprint.
- **Increased** agency technical performance by **53.5%** by leveraging best practices in customer experience, user research, and human-centered design.
- **Founded GSA AI Safety Team**, in coordination with the National Institute of Standards (NIST) and the GSA Chief Data and Privacy Officers.
 - Charged with developing and delivering the foundational approaches to AI use.
 - Primary contributor to the agency's first implementation and distribution of AI tools and chatbots.
 - Tiger team member, build of the first AI chatbot piloted by the agency.
- Set quarterly objectives and key results (OKRs) as part of a cross-functional senior leadership team, consulting in strategic planning by senior executives and enabling all business units to navigate ambiguity.

- Authored the Human-centered Design Guide (HCD) series, the first authoritative, full-cycle documentation of applied HCD practice tested in real projects at the U.S. national scale.
- Spoke by invitation on human-centered design, the implementation of agile practices in cross-functional teams, and measurement strategy for complex spaces at: the Customer Experience Community of Practice (~900 members), the Robotics Processing Community of Practice (~1300 members), and [The Ohio State University HOPES Center](#).

Lead Design Strategist, Office of Customer Experience

GENERAL SERVICES ADMINISTRATION (GSA) | 2020 - 2021

Scoped, monitored, and led the implementation of evidence-based research and solution ideation for agency teams and divisions. Work included providing expert authoritative advice to senior leaders and staff-level offices in new modes of working driven by agile, modular, and scalable product and service development approaches. Led a diverse group resulting in the advance of technology solutions for peer and executive partners.

SELECT ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Developed research for, and implementation of strategy to, reorganize ~230 person Office of Government-wide Policy to reflect unified, customer-centric view.
- Built initial enterprise digital experience “tiger team” in collaboration with agency-wide stakeholders including shared services (IT, HR, Comms) and revenue-generative verticals (Acquisition, Real Property), with support from senior executive leadership.

UX Designer, 18F

GENERAL SERVICES ADMINISTRATION (GSA) | 2020

Developed and prototyped digital solutions for the federal sector. Worked to expand the business unit’s service offerings beyond explicit product development to include capacity building and service design.

SELECT ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Defined the first API redesign for United States Geological Survey (USGS) Water Data for the Nation since 1990s, encompassing **1.5 million daily, unique data points**.
- Redesigned core product, 18F Design Methods cards, to speak to wider array of customers inclusive of senior executives.

Human Innovation Fellow, The Lab At OPM

OFFICE OF PERSONNEL MANAGEMENT (OPM) | 2016 - 2020

Orchestrated large, organizational transformations through design and delivery of strategic products, services, and working methods for agencies such as the U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs (VA; ~340,000 employees), the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC; ~15,000 employees), and the Office of Personnel Management (OPM; ~2,400 employees). Original contributor to the Veterans Experience Office, designing and deploying training and use of human-centered design across the entire federal administration. Worked with stakeholders to socialize, model, and test the use of design research as complement and a priori contributor to scientific method in the CDC’s Injury Center. Directly trained ~2,000 federal employees in design-led strategy, ideation, and craft through The Lab’s training series.

SELECT ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Directly **secured over \$700,000 in combined funding** from VA and GSA to land commission to research, author, and test the Human-centered Design Guide Series for the federal service.
- Revised and implemented core training offerings to reflect the needs of senior leaders across **15 federal organizations**, resulting in the training being use across science, humanities, and military executives.
- Led the research, redesign, and deployment of the new Patient Advocacy Tracking System (PATS), supporting **~680 VA Patient Advocates directly and affecting 8.84 million veterans annually**. This was the first redesign of the legally-required PATS system-of-record since the 1990s, and the first user-centered design of the system.

- Spoke by invitation on human-centered design for [NASA's Jet Propulsion Laboratory](#), the Digital Humanist Society, the Office of the Deputy Secretary of the Department of Veterans Affairs, and other federal and private entities.

Executive Creative Director

ISHMAEL INTERACTIVE | 2012 – 2016

Anticipated market shift to encrypted messaging systems ~3 years prior to WhatsApp and iMessage encryption drives. Pitched to MIT Innovation Lab and Silicon Valley- and Los Angeles-based investors. Secured U.S. utility and design patents for work in peer-to-peer, user-generated encrypted messaging for mobile devices.

SELECT ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Conducted customer and market research into the viability of emoji-based, encrypted messaging service for mobile devices.
- Conceptualized application through human-centered evaluative techniques including paper prototyping, in-person, and remote interview methods.
- Constructed application user interface from wire framing, mock ups, and through final product design.
- Interviewed and managed engineering team of 10+ in back- and front-end construction of mobile application.
- Created drawings of application interface and functionality concept for U.S. Patent Office and spoke directly with Patent Examiner.
- Patent Awarded: Custom Encoded Messages Amongst a Customized Social Group Patent No. US10135778B2 (2015) Issued Nov 20, 2018

Executive Creative Director

ANA MONROE | 2006 – 2016

Created vision and implementation strategies for dozens of photography and film projects to connect with diverse audiences according to production and publication needs. Researched visual identity of characters using historical and ethnographic perspectives. Utilized human-centered design research methodologies such as observational research and interactive research tools.

SELECT ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Implemented Art Department vision on projects exceeding \$3 million.
- Worked with major brands such as Vogue, Adidas, Target, Nike, and the New York Times.
- Managed cross-functional collaborations in high-stress, rapidly evolving work environments with above-the-line leadership and trades, including Producers, Directors, Cinematographers, Teamsters, Carpenters, and Drapers.

Technology, Skills & Thought Leadership

PATENTS

- (2020) Dynamic Typesetting | Patent No. US10769348B1
- (2015) Custom Encoded messages amongst a customized social group | Patent No. US10135778B2

AWARDS

(2023) Service to the Citizen Award | Public Service Leadership Academy

ENTERPRISE DIGITAL EXPERIENCE TEAM, SERVICE DESIGN TEAM; OFFICE OF CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE, GSA

LANGUAGES

- English | Spoken: Proficient; Written: Proficient
- Spanish | Spoken: Fluent; Written: Fluent

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- (2024) Human-centered Design Guide Series
- (2021) How Not to Lose a Talent Pool: Keeping Women at Work Through Crises, Shocks, and Other Disasters
- in the Design Management Institute Review: Creative Leadership
- (2019) The Veterans Experience Offices' Customer Experience Journey
- in the Design Management Institute Review: Creative Leadership

Education

- Formal training in history and applied design through STEM coursework results in platform-agnostic, innovative thinking.
- Leverage history training to unify data and narrative to build meaningful insights and multiple, customer-centered and organizationally-actionable paths forward.
- Applies technical grounding in math, science, and agile, iterative making to create rigorous, engineering-driven approach to strategic and tactical goals. Oversees teams with emphasis on model-making and testing.

Masters of Fine Arts - Sciences, Technology, Engineering, and Maths (MFA-STEM)

ART CENTER COLLEGE OF DESIGN | PASADENA, CA | SEPTEMBER 2014 - APRIL 2016

Major: Media Design Practices

Thesis work: Interlocutor, a product design exploration of human connection through technology, 2016

A.B. - Undergraduate degree - Columbia College

COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY | NEW YORK, NY | AUGUST 2000 - MAY 2004

Major: Modern European History

Recent work from this field: How Not to Lose a Talent Pool: Keeping Women at Work Through Crises, Shocks, and Other Disasters, dmi:Review, Innovative Thinking from Diverse Design Leaders, vol. 32, issue 3, September 2021